



County Council Meeting August 26th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QS7Pn1NJQKo
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Municipal Meeting Summary: Delaware County Council

Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer (President Wyatt) called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order on August 26, 2025, at 9:00 a.m. [00:00:33](#)
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Bookout, Mr. Flanigan, Mr. Mgle (Smoggle), Mr. Hughes, Mr. Can (Canal), Ms. Piper, Mr. Swad (presumed President Wyatt / presiding officer or Swad referenced interchangeably). *Note: The transcript roll call lists members explicitly or colloquially by last names (Bookout, Flanigan, Mgle/Smoggle, Hughes, Canal, Piper, Swad).*
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Wyatt [00:03:02](#)

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Commissioner Brandt [00:03:38](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- The June 24, 2025, meeting minutes (previously tabled) were removed from the table and approved by voice vote / roll call [00:01:45](#) <U+2013> [00:02:44](#).
- The July 22, 2025, meeting minutes were approved with Mr. Smoggle abstaining [00:02:45](#) <U+2013> [00:03:06](#).

Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:03:10](#) **Financial Transfer: County General / Opioid Response Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections [00:03:39](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer of \$7,200 from line 231 (Other Supplies) to line 310 (Professional Services) within Fund 8199 (Opioid Response). The state prohibited purchasing gift cards for probationers; funds will instead support a scholarship program for court-ordered classes at Community Corrections [00:03:41](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:04:13](#).
- [00:04:31](#) **Financial Transfer (Addendum): County General / Courts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator [00:05:00](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer of \$8,673.72 from line 311 (Contractual Services) to line 536 (Equipment) for juvenile courtroom furniture (chairs and table electrical outlets) purchased via Viziant [00:05:09](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:06:42](#).
- [00:06:43](#) **Financial Transfer: Public Defender**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Public Defender's Office [00:07:14](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer of \$11,650 out of line 172 (PERF) into line 174 (Life Insurance: +\$1,250) and line 175 (Disability Insurance: +\$400), covering an overrun and projected shortfalls through year-end [00:07:15](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:07:53](#).
- [00:07:56](#) **Appropriation: County General / Jail**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin, Sheriff's Office [00:08:16](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An additional appropriation of \$150,000 into line 311 (Contractual Services) to cover variable off-site medical services and medications for inmates through year-end [00:08:25](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:13:07](#).

- **00:13:11 Appropriation: Commissioners / Liability Insurance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steven Brandt, County Commissioner's Office **00:13:37**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to address historical under-budgeting of liability and risk insurance. The actual premium is \$1,293,031, whereas \$982,147 was budgeted. Combined with average annual claims (\$250,637) and prior line-item shifts (\$83,000), a larger appropriation was requested. Councilman Hughes moved to amend the requested amount to **\$450,000** to cover an upcoming September 1st invoice (\$168,928), fourth-quarter auto insurance (~\$84,464), and a buffer for claims **00:25:18**.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to amend appropriation amount to \$450,000: Passed Unanimously **00:29:40**.
 - Motion to approve amended appropriation (\$450,000): Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) **00:30:03**.
- **00:30:35 Financial Transfer: County Assessor Sales Disclosure**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** James Carmichael, Assessor **00:30:56**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer of \$3,200 into line 393 (Conferences and Training) for mandatory continuing education and certification hours **00:31:01**.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) **00:31:38**.
- **00:31:43 Appropriation & Transfer: EMS Capital Improvement Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, EMS Director / Megan **00:36:06**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request totaling \$231,636.49 from Fund 4910 (EMS Capital Improvement Fund) for a 3-year Stryker maintenance contract (\$143,894.49) and historical invoice reconciliation caused by a vendor billing mix-up with Delaware County, Ohio (\$87,742.49) **00:32:06**. Amended to structure \$143,894.49 via transfer to contractual line 311 and \$87,742.49 via capital outlay line 550 **00:43:10**.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to amend/approve transfers and capital outlays: Passed Unanimously **00:43:55**.
 - Final approval of amended items: Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) **00:44:48**.
- **00:44:54 Appropriation: Mental Health Treatment Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections **00:45:12**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An appropriation of \$5,000 into line 393 (Conferences and Training) for a new grant received from the Indiana Office of Court Services to support planning and training for a new county mental health court **00:45:14**.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [00:46:10](#).
- **00:47:00 Resolution 2025-12: Assignment of TIFF Collateral (Living Green Bonds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sarah Carell, Ice Miller (Bond Counsel) [00:47:19](#) / Stephen Brandt [00:53:17](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution approving the assignment of TIFF revenues as collateral for a \$16 million private loan sought by a new developer who acquired the failed Living Green project bonds. The developer intends to complete the building shell for an aluminum trailer manufacturing tenant. Council members expressed concern regarding past unfulfilled developer pledges (jobs, wages, capital investments) and the absence of an updated Economic Development Agreement (EDA) with the new operating entity.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to approve failed/superseded by motion to table.
 - Motion to table Resolution 2025-12 (by Bill Bookout, seconded by Jessica): **Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed with opposing votes noted by Mr. Can and Mr. Wyatt)** [01:12:39](#). Tabled for 30 days to gather information on an EDA.
- **01:13:42 Ordinance 2025-14: Rainy Day Fund (First Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ben (Legal Counsel) [01:14:31](#) / Matt [01:14:48](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of an ordinance establishing/updating the county Rainy Day Fund, allowable funding sources, and expenditure categories. Council discussed striking specific restrictive phrasing (e.g., "state-mandated" computer hardware; "non-payment of property taxes" shortfall clauses) and revising finance committee review language.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for First Reading; approved to advance by roll call vote [01:29:07](#).
- **01:29:14 Ordinance 2025-15: Salary Ordinance Amendment (Communications Dispatchers)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications Director) [01:29:54](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A salary ordinance amendment allowing former full-time certified communications dispatchers who transition to part-time status to receive the equivalent base hourly rate of full-time dispatchers (excluding benefits/holidays).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to suspend rules / adopt on first reading: Approved Unanimously by Roll Call [01:34:21](#).

- Motion for final adoption: Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [01:34:44](#).
 - **01:34:50 Ordinance 2025-16: Property Tax Assessment Board of Appeals (PTABOA) Compensation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor's Office / Council President Wyatt [01:34:56](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance updating compensation rates for PTABOA members to eliminate a two-tier pay system (\$150 vs. \$100) and establish a uniform rate, resulting in overall cost savings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to adopt on first reading: Approved Unanimously by Roll Call [01:36:56](#).
 - Motion for final passage/adoption: Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed Unanimously) [01:37:36](#).
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Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:04:46 Julie Meyer:** Executive Director of the Muncie Delaware County Senior Center. Addressed the council regarding the severe impact of losing federal Older Americans Act grant staff on July 1st. Requested council sponsorship/assistance to reopen their thrift store (Ed's Boutique and Thrift) to restore essential operating income (\$1,000<U+2013>\$2,000/month) used to pay utility bills.
 - **02:10:24 Rick Yenser:** Local newsman and author. Addressed tax burdens, rising property assessments across Delaware County, and urged transparency regarding upcoming county budget hearings and tax rates.
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Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Auditor's Office:** Tanya Dunmore announced that for the first time ever, Delaware County completed its State Board of Accounts and Forvis audit process one month early [01:49:33](#).
 - **Coroner's Office:** Gavin Green reported 454 year-to-date cases (projecting ~693 for 2025) and addressed an autopsy fee increase negotiation with East Central Pathologists [01:50:23](#).
 - **Communications / 911:** Fred warned that the county's emergency radio system reaches end-of-life in 2030 (estimated \$2M replacement cost needed by 2029) and critiqued the efficiency of single monthly council meetings and preliminary finance committee sessions [01:57:55](#).
 - **Commissioners:** Stephen Brand announced the hiring of a new county degreed civil engineer, Dean Thomas, starting September 29th [02:02:51](#). Mentioned the

Muncie Planning Commission interlocal funding agreement is finalized with the mayor committing \$25,000 01:45:11.

- **Upcoming Schedule:** Budget hearings begin September 3, 2025 02:12:04. The next regularly scheduled council meeting is September 23, 2025, at 9:00 a.m. 02:14:29.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following a motion by Jessica and second by Dan, approved by unanimous roll call 02:14:14.

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